

Terraform Associate Certification – Preparation Guide

Exam Overview

- Certification: HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- Exam Duration: 60 minutes
- Questions: ~57 multiple-choice questions
- Delivery: Online through Pearson VUE
- Focus: Terraform basics, workflow, state, modules, and Terraform Cloud concepts

Key Topics to Study

- Infrastructure as Code (IaC) concepts
- Terraform architecture and providers
- Terraform CLI workflow (init, plan, apply, destroy)
- Variables, outputs, and local values
- Terraform state and state management
- Modules and reusable infrastructure
- Remote backends (S3)
- Terraform Cloud and workspaces

Important Terraform Commands

Command	Purpose
terraform init	Initializes working directory and downloads providers
terraform validate	Checks configuration syntax
terraform plan	Shows execution plan before applying changes
terraform apply	Creates or updates infrastructure
terraform destroy	Removes infrastructure created by Terraform

3■Week Study Plan

- Week 1: Terraform basics, providers, resources, and CLI workflow.
- Week 2: Variables, outputs, modules, and Terraform state concepts.
- Week 3: Remote backends, Terraform Cloud, workspaces, and practice tests.

Hands■On Practice Ideas

- Create an EC2 instance using Terraform.
- Build a VPC with subnets using Terraform.
- Store Terraform state in an S3 backend.
- Create reusable Terraform modules.

Sample Exam Questions

- What does 'terraform init' do?
- What is the purpose of the Terraform state file?
- What is a Terraform module?
- Which command shows the changes Terraform will make before applying them?